

DR. THARINDU ATTANAYAKE

DBA (Fin), MPA, BBus (Acc/Fin), FIPA, FFA



"I am a self-motivated, results-oriented industry professional and academic with a strong grasp of management and financial accounting procedures in both Australian public and private sector businesses. I believe accounting is more than just rules and numbers. Every financial statement tells a story about a business, its health, its values, and its future. My goal is to change how we teach accounting: instead of just focusing on technical steps, I help students learn how to find these hidden stories in the data. In my classroom, we go beyond debits and credits. I teach students how to listen to what the numbers are telling us and use that understanding to make smarter business decisions."



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Sydney, Australia

SKILLS

Technical Skills

SAP, MYOB, Oracle, Quick Books, Acc Pack, Xero, Pronto, Read-soft, KOFAX, Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, Moodle, Turnitin and Canvas.

Soft Skills

Self-Motivated, Adoptable, Friendly, Results-Oriented, Flexible, Team Player and a Fast Learner

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Diverse Teaching Expertise** – Proven ability to teach accounting, finance, auditing, and numerous business units across multiple disciplines (economics, marketing, management, international business, etc.) for both undergraduate and postgraduate levels.
- **Curriculum & Assessment Design** – Experience developing TEQSA-compliant course materials, assessments, and rubrics for face to face, online and hybrid learning environments.
- **Student Success Focus** – Dedicated to academic counselling, early identification of at-risk students, and implementing tailored support strategies.
- **Financial Expertise** – Strong background in budgeting, financial forecasting, variance analysis, and accounts payable/receivable management.
- **Leadership & Compliance** – Skilled in course and unit coordination, ensuring policy adherence, and maintaining robust internal control systems.

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS

- **Doctor of Business Administration**
LIGS University, Honolulu, USA- (1st Jan 2021 – 14th July 2023)
 - **Master of Professional Accounting**
Kaplan Business School, SA, Australia - (10th Jul 2019 – 20th Jun 2020)
 - **Bachelor of Business (Accounting & Finance)**
University of Technology Sydney, NSW, Australia - (10th Feb 2014 – 13th Mar 2017)
 - **Diploma of Project Management**
Southern Cross Education Institute, SA, Australia - (27th Aug 2020 – 27th Aug 2022)
 - **Diploma of Computerized Accounting**
British Informatics Computer Technology, Colombo, Sri Lanka - (18th Apr 2005 – 23rd Sep 2005)
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PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- **Fellow Member - IPA**
Institute of Public Accountants Australia - (From 2023 onwards)
 - **AATSL Passed Finalist**
Association of Accounting Technicians in Sri Lanka - (27th Feb 2002 – 10th Apr 2006)
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WORK EXPERIENCE – ACADEMIC

Lecturer in Accounting

Crown Institute of Higher Education – North Sydney Campus
Full Time / November 1, 2023 – Present

- Recognized with the 2025 Teaching Excellence Award for innovative, engaging, and effective teaching practices.
- Teaching a range of business units, with a primary focus on accounting and finance, to both undergraduate and postgraduate cohorts.
- Developed unit content, assessments, and marking rubrics aligned with TEQSA-approved unit outlines to ensure academic rigor and compliance.
- Designed and delivered educational activities that foster student engagement and support diverse learning styles.
- Administered assessments in a manner that was both fair and reliable.
- Monitored student progress and provided timely academic counselling to support individual achievement and growth.
- Maintained accurate and up-to-date student records in accordance with institutional requirements.
- Contributed actively to staff meetings and participated in ongoing professional development sessions to enhance teaching practice and stay current with sector developments.

- Engaged in academic research and scholarly activities to contribute to the discipline and inform teaching.
- Ensured all activities were conducted in compliance with relevant policies and standards.
- Managed administrative responsibilities efficiently as required by the role.
- Participated in promotional activities to support the institution's outreach and engagement initiatives.

Lecturer / Unit coordinator – Sports Business

Australian Collage of Physical Education – Olympic Park Campus

Part Time / July 22, 2024 – June 30, 2025

- Developed and taught accounting and finance courses for sports businesses, covering budgets for teams, events, and facilities.
- Made real-world assignments like analyzing club finances and calculating costs for recreation programs.
- Created hands-on activities: predicting costs for sports tournaments and calculating break-even points for gyms.
- Helped different types of learners - student-athletes in class and working professionals studying online.
- Gave career advice for jobs in sports finance and recreation management.
- Used examples from actual sports clubs to show how accounting works.
- Followed all university rules while keeping content practical for the sports industry.
- Taught the same material effectively both in-person and online.

Lecturer / Course Coordinator

Apex Australia Higher Education – Parramatta Campus

Full Time / March 1, 2023 – October 31, 2023

- Developed course curriculum to align with program outcomes.
- Collaborated with leadership to establish timetables and onboard faculty for multiple campuses.
- Managed support programs for at-risk students.
- Conducted evaluations for special considerations and academic misconduct cases.
- Sourced technical requirements for course delivery.
- Prepared and maintained online course delivery platforms.
- Delivered lectures on Accounting, Economics, Management, and Marketing.
- Assisted in budgeting, assessment, and quality assurance.
- Oversaw assessment administration and moderation.
- Provided course-specific advice to students.
- Mentored academic staff.
- Supported internal control systems.

Lecturer

Victoria University Sydney

Casual / Contract – October 3, 2023 – November 30, 2023

- Delivered high-quality lectures and tutorials under block mode.
- Managed online learning systems in hybrid setup.
- Created an innovative learning environment for students.
- Identified and supported at-risk students.

- Participated in university events and professional development.
- Ensured quality assessment and examination processes.

Lecturer / Unit Coordinator

Canterbury Institute of Management – Sydney Campus
Casual / Contract – January 31, 2023 – April 30, 2023

- Taught Accounting Information Systems (Undergraduate).
- Updated subject material and provided feedback on assessments and tests.
- Reported students at risk.

Lecturer / Unit Coordinator

Australian Institute of Higher Education - Sydney Campus
Casual / Contract – March 27, 2023 – May 30, 2023

- Taught Accounting Information Systems in block mode.
- Updated subject material and provided feedback on assessments and tests.
- Reported students at risk.

Lecturer / Unit Coordinator

Melbourne Institute of Technology - Sydney Campus
Casual / Ongoing / Contract – March 24, 2021 – April 30, 2023

- Taught various business, accounting and finance units.
- Prepared and updated study materials.
- Integrated financial software into subject content.
- Designed assignments and provided timely feedback.
- Reported students at risk.

Finance Lecturer / Curriculum Developer

International College of Hotel Management – ICHM
Casual / Contract – December 8, 2020 – June 24, 2021

- Developed curriculum for online undergraduate and postgraduate programs.
- Lectured Hospitality Management Accounting and Business Financial Performance.
- Prepared course materials and schedules.
- Corrected exam papers and awarded grades.
- Provided individual guidance to students.
- Incorporated supplementary materials within their context of hospitality to enhanced understanding.

WORK EXPERIENCE – CORPORATE

Commercial Analyst

Servicing SA
Part Time / Ongoing / Contract - July 20, 2020 – October 11, 2021

- Produced accurate management accounting information for data-driven decision-making.
- Analyzed financial reports, adjusted budgetary stats, and compared actual performance with

forecasts.

- Conducted variance analysis for purchasing, service contracts, and capital financing.
- Prepared monthly ratio analysis reports using spreadsheets and visual aids.
- Assisted in budgeting, forecasting, and evaluating cash flow and financial risk.
- Provided financial recommendations on business structures and operations.
- Oversaw the Fixed Assets Register and performed reconciliations.
- Prepared and processed month-end adjustments, accruals, prepayments, and journals.
- Assisted with Accounts Payable, Accounts Receivable, and Payroll processing.
- Evaluated and improved internal control systems.

Finance Support Officer – A/P

Department of Family and Community Services NSW - FACS

Full Time / Ongoing / Contract - March 19, 2018 – June 30, 2019

- Consistently achieved or exceeded daily KPIs as an Accounts Payable Specialist.
- Diligently processed 200+ invoices daily with high accuracy, following FACS and ATO guidelines.
- Managed urgent invoices, ensuring payments within 24 hours, following obligatory approvals.
- Expertly reconciled supplier statements, promptly resolving outstanding issues.
- Prioritized workload based on payment run cycles, guaranteeing on-time payments to contracting agencies and proactively detected and resolved discrepancies in bank and purchase order details.
- Responded promptly to inquiries via phone, email, and FACS ServiceNow ticket system.

Accounts Payable Officer

Health Shared Services NSW - HSNSW

Full Time / Ongoing / Contract - June 18, 2017 – March 18, 2018

- Processed accounts payable transactions with a focus on customer satisfaction.
- Achieved daily KPIs for invoice processing with high accuracy and streamlined internal staff reimbursement processes.
- Responded to customer inquiries on accounts payable matters.

Accounts Receivable Officer

Data Management Systems (Pvt) Ltd - DMS Holdings

Full Time / Permanent - September 1, 2009 – August 31, 2011

- Managed daily records and cash flow expectations.
- Settled receipts into Oracle with high accuracy and reconciled bank statements.
- Managed debt collection and responded to customer inquiries regarding credit sales.

Account Assistant

East West Marketing (Pvt) Ltd - EWM

Full Time / Permanent - June 1, 2006 – June 21, 2009

- Handled bookkeeping, data entry, and administrative tasks.
- Prepared daily banking deposits, reconciled petty cash, and managed cash reports.
- Coordinated deliveries and processed payments and invoices.
- Assisted with data entry and bookkeeping for AP and AR teams.

PUBLICATIONS & RESEARCH WORK

Journal Articles Published and Accepted

- Attanayake, T. (2024, July 7). *How Technological Connectivity Has Helped in Integrated Financial Management*. LIGS University Blog. Retrieved from <https://ligsuniversity.com/how-technological-connectivity-has-helped-in-integrated-financial-management/>
- Attanayake, T. & Goonaratne, G. (Accepted for publication). *The Future of Auditing: AI and Emerging Technologies for Quality and Value*. IUP Journal of Accounting Research and Audit Practices.

Under Review

- Attanayake, T. & Goonaratne, G. (in final review). *The Impact of Generative AI on International Business Strategies and Corporate Practices in the SAARC Region*. With IUP Journal of Accounting Research and Audit Practices.

Conference Papers and Presentations

- Attanayake, T. & Goonaratne, G. (2025, November 8). *Balancing Innovation and Integrity: Comparative Policy Frameworks for AI Governance in Australian Higher Education*. For 2025 the 8th ICETM (International Conference on Educational Technology Management) at Guangzhou University China.
- Attanayake, T. (2023, April 29). *Impact of Coronavirus on International Trade Relations*. Paper presented at the 12th ICMPR (International Conference on Management Practices and Research) at Apeejay School of Management, New Delhi, India.
- Attanayake, T. (2023, April 29). *Ethical Concerns Associated with Corporate Finance and How They Can Be Managed*. Paper presented at the 12th ICMPR (International Conference on Management Practices and Research) at Apeejay School of Management, New Delhi, India.

Doctoral Dissertation Thesis

- Sustainability Accounting in International Trade: Comparison between South Asia and Oceania

REFEREES

Available upon request.